Where to Publish This Paper — Venue Guide & Submission Playbook

Prepared for: Mostafa Adawy (Odin Markets)

Date: June 2026

What kind of paper this is (read first)

This work is an **experience / systems report**: a working multi-agent development system, an un-gameable evaluation methodology, and real incidents (a production outage, a caught self-deceiving test). It is **not** a new model or a benchmarked state-of-the-art result.

That matters for venue choice. The best fits are venues that **explicitly value practical impact, real deployments, and lessons learned over novelty** — namely *industry* and *software-engineering-in-practice* tracks, and practitioner magazines. Pure-research tracks (which reward novelty and ablations) are a harder sell *unless* you first add the quantitative study described in the paper's Limitations section.

> **One-line strategy:** post to arXiv now (timestamp + shareable link), then submit to an industry/SE-in-practice track, and in parallel pitch a practitioner magazine. Use a workshop for fast early feedback if you want reviews before a main deadline.

Recommendation tiers

Tier 0 — Do this immediately: arXiv preprint

- **Why:** Free, no peer review, permanent timestamp that establishes priority, and a link you can cite/share everywhere. Costs nothing and forecloses nothing — most of the venues below explicitly allow a prior arXiv preprint.
- **Categories:** primary `cs.SE` (Software Engineering); cross-list `cs.MA` (Multiagent Systems) and `cs.AI`.
- **Recommendation:** ★★★★★ (do it this week).
- **Steps:** see "How to submit to arXiv" below.

Tier 1 — Best peer-reviewed fit (industry / in-practice tracks)

These prize *impact and real experience over novelty*, and most are **single-blind** (you do **not** anonymize), which suits a named system report.

Venue (track)	Why it fits	Timing (verify!)	Recommendation
ASE 2026 — Industry Showcase	"Prioritize impact and realistic applications over novelty… success stories and experiences." Exactly this paper. Long papers 10+2 pp, single-blind, mandatory data-availability statement. Munich, Oct 12–16 2026.	Submission window typically spring/summer 2026 — **verify now**, may be near.	★★★★★
ICSE 2027 — SEIP (Software Eng. in Practice)	Premier practitioner track at the top SE conference; not double-anonymous.	**Abstracts ~Jun 23 2026, papers ~Jun 30 2026 — imminent.** If you can move fast this is the highest-prestige near-term shot.	★★★★★ (if you can hit the date)
FSE 2026 — Industry Papers	Top-tier SE venue, dedicated industry track; ACM template, PDF.	Check the track page for the 2026 date.	★★★★☆

Tier 2 — Practitioner magazines (great for experience reports)

Lighter, editor-driven review; wide readership; fast-ish; very friendly to "what we built and learned" narratives.

- **IEEE Software** — practitioners' articles & themed issues on AI-assisted software engineering. ★★★★☆
- **ACM Queue / Communications of the ACM (Practice)** — engineer-written, high-visibility practice articles. ★★★★☆

Tier 3 — Workshops (fast feedback, lower bar, good first step)

Short papers, quick turnaround; ideal to get reviews and a citation while you target a Tier-1 track.

- **LLM-Agent workshops at NeurIPS / ICML / ICLR** (recurring; titles vary, e.g. "LLM Agents", "Foundation Models for Decision Making", "Open-World Agents"). ★★★★☆
- **LLM4Code** (typically co-located with ICSE). ★★★★☆
- **MABS / multi-agent workshops at AAMAS** (AAMAS 2026 main track deadlines already passed — Dec 2025 — but workshops stayed open into Feb 2026; watch AAMAS 2027). ★★★☆☆

Tier 4 — Journals (only after you add the quantitative study)

If you expand with the controlled cache-vs-no-cache numbers and a fuller evaluation, these become strong:

- **EMSE — Empirical Software Engineering (Springer)** — experience + empirics. ★★★★☆
- **Automated Software Engineering journal (Springer)** — has open CFP collections. ★★★☆☆

- **ACM TOSEM / IEEE TSE** — highest prestige, highest bar; needs full study. ★★★☆☆

Living deadline trackers (bookmark these)

Deadlines move every year — always confirm on the official track page, and use:

- **se-deadlines.github.io** — software-engineering venues (ICSE, FSE, ASE, …).
- **aideadlines.org** — AI/ML venues and workshops (NeurIPS, ICML, ICLR, AAMAS).

Step-by-step: how to submit

How to submit to arXiv (Tier 0)

1. Create/confirm an account at arxiv.org. New authors may need an **endorsement** for `cs.SE`/`cs.MA` (a one-time step; the site guides you).
2. Prepare the source: upload **the LaTeX** `.tex` **plus the generated** `.pdf` (arXiv prefers source). Our `odin_paper.tex` compiles cleanly with `pdflatex`.
3. Choose **primary** `cs.SE`, cross-list `cs.MA`, `cs.AI`.
4. Add title, abstract (paste from the paper), authors, and a license (CC BY 4.0 is a good default).
5. Submit → it appears after a short moderation hold. Share the resulting `arXiv:XXXX.XXXXX` link.

How to submit to an SE industry / in-practice track (Tier 1)

1. **Pick the track** and open its `conf.researchr.org` page; read the Call for Papers for the exact **page limit, template, and blinding rule**.
2. **Template:** use the **ACM Primary Article Template** (these tracks use ACM format). *Our paper is currently in a generic two-column article style — you will need to port it into the ACM template before submitting.* (Easy: copy the sections into the ACM `acmart` skeleton.)
3. **Blinding:** ASE Industry Showcase, ICSE SEIP, and FSE Industry are **single-blind** — keep your name and "Odin" in the paper.
4. **Data-availability statement:** ASE requires one *after the Conclusion, within the page limit*, with a DOI-archived artifact (e.g., a Zenodo deposit of the evaluation scripts). Prepare this.
5. **Register the paper** on the track's HotCRP site (e.g., `ase26-industry.hotcrp.com`), submit the **abstract first** if an abstract deadline precedes the paper deadline, then upload the **PDF**.
6. Wait for reviews; prepare a short rebuttal if the track offers one.

How to pitch a practitioner magazine (Tier 2)

1. Read the magazine's author guidelines (length is shorter — ~3,000–5,000 words, fewer equations, more narrative).
2. For IEEE Software, check current **themed-issue CFPs** (AI for SE appears regularly) or submit to the practitioners' department.
3. For ACM Queue, email the editors a **short pitch** (2–3 paragraphs) first; they commission/curate.
4. Trim the math, lead with the two incidents and the un-gameable-test idea — magazines reward a strong story.

How to submit to a workshop (Tier 3)

1. Find a current LLM-agent workshop via **aideadlines.org**.

2. Most accept **4–8 page** short papers; many are **non-archival** (so you can still submit the full paper to a Tier-1 venue afterward — check the policy).
3. Submit via the workshop's OpenReview/HotCRP/EasyChair link.

A concrete plan (suggested order)

1. **This week:** put `odin_paper.pdf` on **arXiv** (`cs.SE`). Get the link.
2. **Now:** decide on **ICSE 2027 SEIP** — its paper deadline (~Jun 30 2026) is the nearest high-prestige target; if reachable, port to the ACM template and submit. If not, target **ASE 2026 Industry Showcase** / **FSE 2026 Industry**.
3. **In parallel:** prepare a **Zenodo artifact** (the evaluation gate + cache scripts, secrets removed) and a one-line DOI for the data-availability statement.
4. **Strengthen for a journal later:** run the cache-vs-no-cache timing study, add the numbers, and extend to **EMSE**.
5. **Optional fast feedback:** drop a short version into an **LLM-agent workshop** to collect reviews while the main submission is in flight.

Pre-submission checklist

- ☐ Camera-ready quantitative results filled in (timing study) — or clearly framed as an experience report if submitting before then.
- ☐ Correct **template** for the target venue (ACM `acmart` for SE tracks).
- ☐ **Page limit** respected (e.g., 10+2 for ASE Industry).
- ☐ **Blinding** rule applied correctly (single-blind for the Tier-1 tracks).
- ☐ **Data-availability statement** + DOI artifact (Zenodo).
- ☐ No secrets/credentials anywhere in paper or artifact.
- ☐ arXiv preprint posted and linked.
- ☐ Deadline re-confirmed on the official track page **today**.

Note on dates: venue deadlines change yearly and some windows above are close or may have shifted. Every date here should be re-confirmed on the official track page (links via se-deadlines.github.io / aideadlines.org) before you rely on it.